



Chapter 2

Individual Behavior and Learning in an Organization

Chapter Outline



- Perception and Individual Decision Making
- Attitude
- Personality
- Learning

Perception and Individual Decision Making

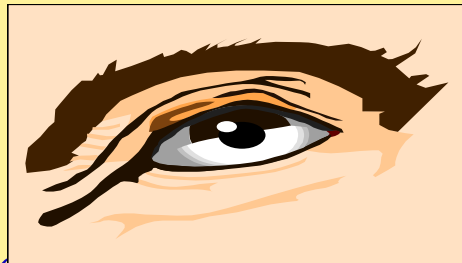


1. What is perception?
2. What causes people to have different perceptions of the same situation?
3. Can people be mistaken in their perceptions?
4. Does perception really affect outcomes?

What is Perception?



Definition: A process by which individuals organize and interpret their sensory impressions in order to give meaning to their environment (Robbins)



✓ Perception is like beauty that lies in the eyes of beholder

- What one perceives may be substantially different from reality !
Example: A person coming late on duty may be perceived as casual and tardy while there may be social problems faced by him/her.*

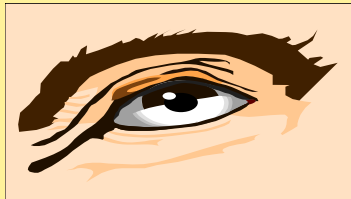
Why We Study Perceptions?



- For better understanding
- We don't see reality. We interpret
- The attribution process guides our behavior



Factors that Influence Perception



Factors in the **situation**

- Time
- Work setting
- Social setting

Factors in the **perceiver**

- Attitudes
- Motives
- Interests
- Experience
- Expectations

Perception

Factors in the **target**

- Novelty
- Motion
- Sounds
- Size
- Background
- Proximity

Attribution Theory

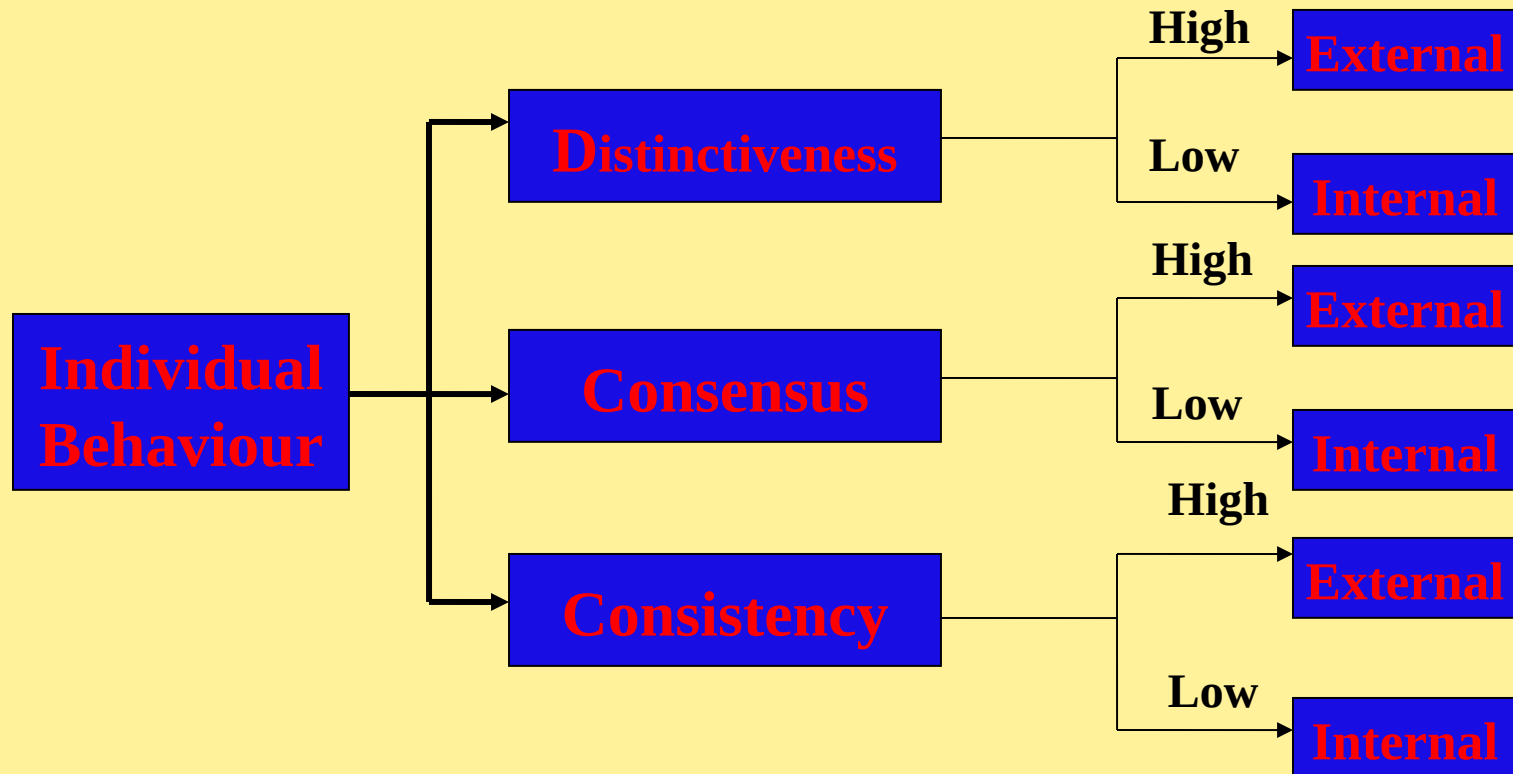


- *Attempt to explain the ways we judge people, based on the meaning we attribute to their behaviour*
- *It has been seen that our perception about the people is greatly influenced by the assumption we make about a person and not by reality.*
- *Attribution theory suggest that when we evaluate human behavior, it is either internally caused or it is caused due to external factors*
- *That is, Causes of behaviour can be:*
 - *External (situation or environment)*
 - *Internal (believed to be under the personal control of the individual)*
- *Whether attribution is internal or external depends on*
 - *Distinctiveness*
 - *Consensus*
 - *Consistency*

Attribution Theory



Observation → interpretation → Causes



Attribution Theory of perception



- Fundamental Attribution Error
 - The tendency to underestimate external factors.
- Self-Serving Bias
 - The tendency to attribute one's successes to internal factors and failures to external factors.

Common Perceptual Errors



- Selective Perception
 - *People selectively interpret what they see based on their attitude, interest, background and experience.*
- Halo Effect
 - Drawing a general impression (*judging an individual based on single characteristics, such as intellectual ability, sociability and appearance*).
- Contrast Effects
 - A person's evaluation.
 - *We do not evaluate a person in isolation. Our reaction to one person is relative to the other*

Perceptual Errors



- Projection
 - Attributing one's own characteristics
 - *You assume a person based on your own traits and not what he actually possesses (e.g. If you were hard working and dependable you would expect others to be so)*
- Stereotyping
 - Judging someone
 - *In order to simplify matters, we often tend to classify people and events into already known categories (e.g. we generally perceive man as executive and woman as secretary even if the situation may be different)*
- Prejudice
 - An unfounded dislike

Why Do Perceptions and Judgment Matter?



- Self-Fulfilling Prophecy
 - A concept that proposes a person will behave in ways consistent with how he or she is perceived by others.

Attitude



- According to G.W. Allport, *“Attitude is a mental and neutral state of readiness organized through experience, exerting a directive or dynamic influence upon individual’s response to all objects and situations with which it is related.”*

Attitudes



- *Attitudes are evaluative statements concerning objects, people or event*
- *Attitudes come from parents, teachers, peer group members etc.*
- *Attitudes can directly effect work behaviour*

Components of Attitude



- *Cognitive component*- Opinion or belief segment
- *Affective component*- Emotional or feeling segment
- *Behavioral component*- Intention to behave in a certain way toward someone or something

Types of Job Related Attitudes



Job Satisfaction

Job Involvement

Organizational Commitment

Job satisfaction



- An individual's general attitude toward his/her job.
 - A high level of job satisfaction equals positive attitudes toward the job and vice versa.
- Employee attitudes and job satisfaction are frequently used interchangeably.

Job involvement



- The measure of the degree to which a person identifies **psychologically** with his/her job and considers his/her perceived performance level important to self-worth.
 - High levels of job involvement
 - Fewer absences and lower resignation rates
- More consistently predicts turnover than absenteeism

Organizational commitment



An **affective and emotional attachment** held by employees towards their work.

Factors

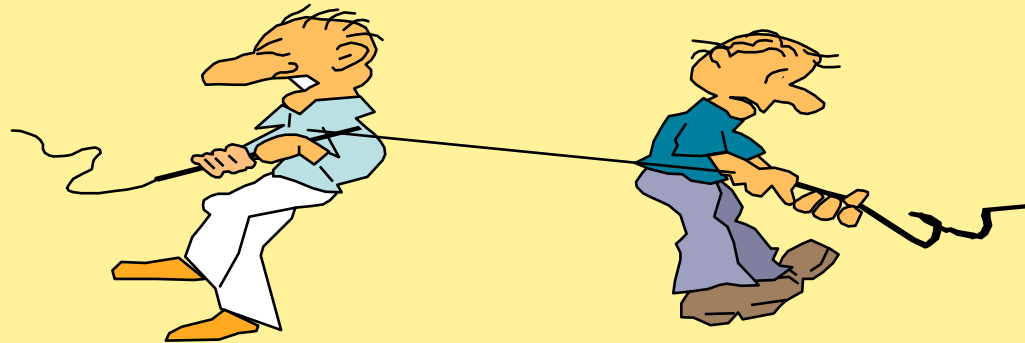


Organizational commitment



- Negative relationships between organizational commitment and both absenteeism and turnover.
 - Organizational commitment is a better indicator of turnover than the job satisfaction is
 - It is a more global and enduring response to the organization as a whole than is job satisfaction.
- As employment becomes less permanent (casuals, contracts etc.) organisational commitment may now be less important than in the past
 - May be being replaced by occupational commitment

Cognitive Dissonance



Any incompatibility between two or more attitudes or between behavior and attitudes.

Personality



- ❖ **The sum total of ways in which an individual reacts and interacts with others.**
- ❖ **The consistent psychological patterns within an individual that affect the way they interact with others and the situations they encounter**
 - **Personality Traits**
 - **Enduring characteristics that describe an individual's behavior.**

Personality determinants

(Nature & Nurture)



❖ Heredity



❖ Environment



❖ Situation



Big Five Model of Personality



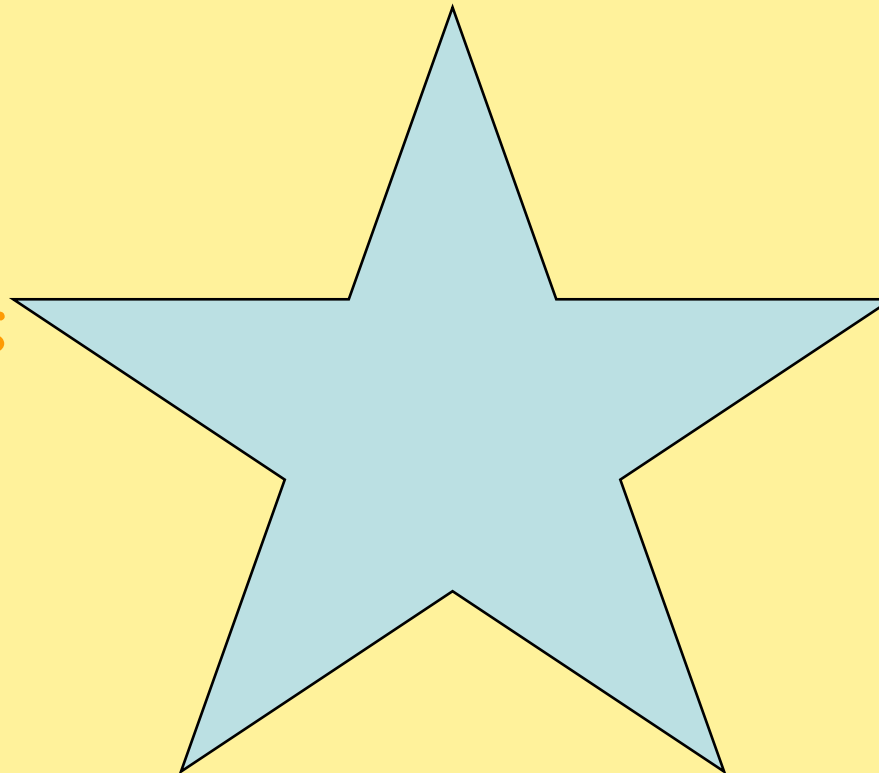
Extraversion

*Emotional
Stability*

Agreeableness

Conscientiousness

Open to experience





The Big Five Model

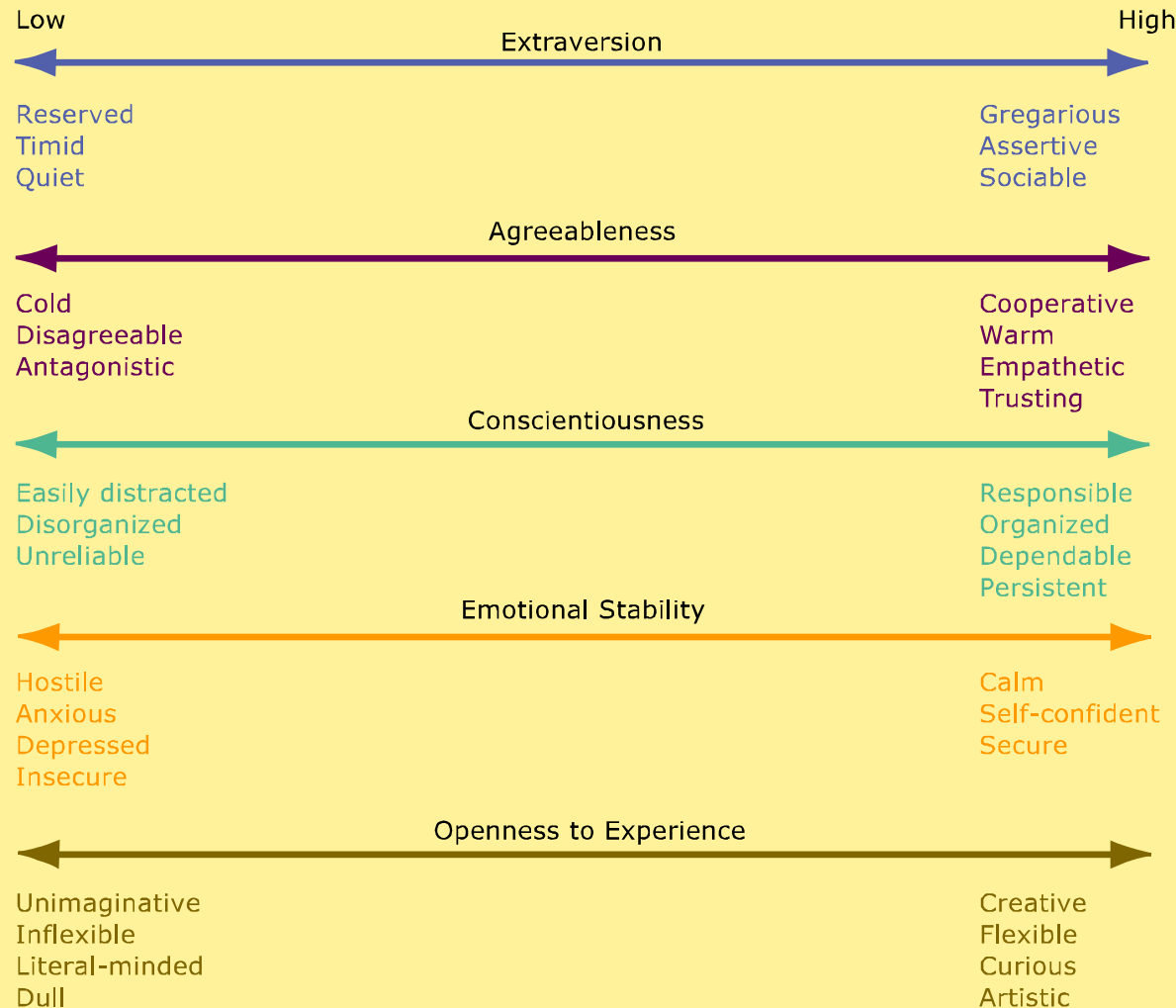
Classifications

- Extraversion
 - friendly, outgoing
 - spend a lot of time maintaining and enjoying
- Agreeableness
 - Highly agreeable = value harmony more
 - Low agreeable = focus more on their own needs
- Conscientiousness
 - Highly conscientious = pursues fewer goals
 - Low conscientious = tend to be more easily distracted

The Big Five Model



- Emotional Stability
 - Positive emotional stability = calm, enthusiastic
 - Negative emotional stability = nervous, depressed,
- Openness to Experience
 - Extremely open = fascinated by novelty
 - Not open = appear more conventional





Major Personality Attributes Influencing Organizational Behavior

- Locus of Control
- Machiavellianism
- Self-Esteem
- Self-Monitoring
- Risk-Taking
- Type A Personality
- Type B Personality
- Proactive Personality

Locus of Control



- The degree to which people believe they are in control of their own fate.
 - Internals
 - Individuals who believe that they control what happens to them.
 - Externals
 - Individuals who believe that what happens to them is controlled by outside forces such as luck or chance.

Machiavellianism



- Degree to which an individual is pragmatic, maintains emotional distance, and believes that ends can justify means.
- A new model of Machiavellianism based in organizational settings consists of three factors: *maintaining power, harsh management tactics, manipulative behaviors.*

Self-Esteem



- Individuals' degree of liking or disliking of themselves.
- Self-esteem reflects a person's overall subjective emotional evaluation of his or her own worth.
- It is a judgment of oneself as well as an attitude toward the self.

Self-Monitoring



- A personality trait that measures an individual's ability to adjust behaviour to external situational factors.
- It is defined as a personality trait that refers to an ability to **regulate behavior** to accommodate social situations.
- People concerned with their expressive self-presentation tend to closely monitor their audience in order to ensure appropriate or desired public appearances.

Risk-Taking



- Refers to a person's willingness to take chances or risks.
- The act or fact of doing something that involves danger or risk in order to achieve a goal.
- Starting a business always involves some risk-taking.

Type A Personality



- Moves
- Impatient
- Multitasks
- Dislikes leisure
- Obsessed with numbers

Type B Personality



- Never suffers
- Doesn't need to display
- Plays for fun
- Can relax

Proactive Personality



- A person who identifies opportunities, shows initiative, takes action, and perseveres until meaningful change occurs.

Learning



Definition:

any relatively permanent change in behavior that occurs as a result of experience

Theories:

Classical conditioning

Operant conditioning

Social learning



Learning



Have a reading Assignment on Learning (Theories of learning and Methods of shaping Behavior)



Summary and Implications

1. What is perception?
 - Perception is the process by which individuals organize and interpret their impressions in order to give meaning to their environment.
2. What causes people to have different perceptions of the same situation?
 - Perceptions are affected by factors in the *perceiver*, in the object or *target* being perceived, and in the context or *situation*.



Summary and Implications

- 3. Can people be mistaken in their perceptions?
 - **Shortcuts**, such as attribution theory, selective perception, halo effect, contrast effects, projection, and stereotyping are helpful and even necessary, but can and do get us in trouble.
- 3. Does perception really affect outcomes?
 - Perceptions often affect productivity more than the situation does.



Summary and Implications

5. What is personality and how does it affect behaviour?
 - Personality helps us predict behaviour.
 - Personality can help match people to jobs, to some extent at least.